

English Class Study Notes

Addictions in Modern Life & How to Cope

现代生活中的成瘾问题与应对

2026-05-17

1. Class Opening & Overview 课程开场

Warm-up: Reviewing Previous Topics

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Talk about how to eat healthy, and the method how to exercise."

Teacher: "Yeah, different kinds of exercise."

Teacher: "So that's the basics. An anyone did anything fun during the weekend though?"

Teacher: "Nothing? Yeah, what you do?"

Teacher: "Ok, do you have dancing exercise? Ok, anything else?"

Teacher: "Last time we also talked about like exercises, and people had like different ideas of what they like to do."

Teacher: "They have some fun, be in shape, and whatnot."

Introducing Today's Topic: Distraction & Addiction

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Now, today, it's kind of also connected to the topic from before, right?"

Teacher: "In this modern world, we have like lots of distractions."

Teacher: "You guys know what distractions mean?"

Teacher: "Like, for example, if you want to do something, really want to do something, and there're like so many things around you that kind of like pull your attention away, right?"

Teacher: "For same thing like that's what we talked about exercises and whatnot, how to be healthy."

Teacher: "Why? Because in today's age, we have lots of... I don't know this word. Addictions."

Today's Topic

This class explores addiction problems in modern life: causes, types, and solutions at both individual and societal levels. Key concepts: dopamine, willpower, FOMO, dopamine fasting, and practical strategies.

2. What is Addiction? 什么是成瘾？

2.1 Defining Addiction 定义成瘾

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Addictions is like you do something that's maybe not good for you, but you cannot stop."
Teacher: "Heard before, but I forgot what's that mean."
Teacher: "So, for example, what is like the number one addiction people think? Smoking, right?"
Teacher: "Smoking can be a verb, and that's one kind of addiction."
Teacher: "What other addictions do people have? Anyone else?"
Teacher: "Coffee? Sure, yeah, we can just say caffeine. People drink coffee because of this mainly."
Teacher: "Sometimes it's for flavor, right? So caffeine can be one thing, anything else?"
Teacher: "Shopping, very good. Especially in today's world."
Teacher: "Shopping is like so easy, you just go through the app. Apps we say, and you can just shop everywhere."

Word / Phrase	Pronunciation	Meaning	Example from Class
addiction	/ədɪkʃən/	成瘾；瘾	Smoking is one kind of addiction.
caffeine	/kæfiːn/	咖啡因	People drink coffee because of caffeine.
nicotine	/nɪkətiːn/	尼古丁	Nicotine is in cigarettes.
shopping addiction		购物成瘾	Shopping is so easy now.

2.2 Why Do People Get Addicted? 为什么会成瘾？

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "What do you like all these things like having common? Why are they addictions?"
Teacher: "Can anybody explain that part? Why do people like shopping?"
Teacher: "It's because like all these things they work the same way."
Teacher: "They make you feel happy, and this happy thing is quality. Well, this is a bit of a sciencey word."
Teacher: "It's called dopamine. Dopamine, everybody has this, your body makes it by itself."
Teacher: "Like you don't need to do anything, but dopamine is only made when like you do something and you succeed."
Teacher: "And then your body is like, ah, I did something, I'm a winner, right? Sound like that, so you feel happy."

The Dopamine Mechanism

Dopamine is a chemical your body produces when you succeed at something. It makes you feel happy, like a reward. All addictive activities work the same way — they give you dopamine.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Do you remember when you were a child, you cannot ride your bicycle or whatnot?"

Teacher: "And you try try, and then finally you succeed. You feel so happy."

Teacher: "That's this, right? Now, when we get have fee long time ago, which is hard to get."

Teacher: "Long time is hard to get, so you get something. Oh, that will win, feel good."

Teacher: "Right, when you like smoke, same thing, right? We have a nicotine, right?"

Teacher: "It's same thing in plants. You get it sometimes, and it kind of helps you, it's kind of medicine."

Teacher: "Shopping also, long time ago, something broken, you cannot throw it away, you must fix it yourself."

Teacher: "But now all these things are very easy, and we get too much."

2.3 The Problem: Too Much Dopamine 多巴胺过多的问题

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "And when we get too much, what happens?"

Teacher: "We can't stop. Well, we cannot stop. Oh, why it can't be stopped?"

Teacher: "Like all things in life you do that give you good feeling have dopamine."

Teacher: "But some give you more, some give you less."

Teacher: "Like, you are tired, go for a walk. You will have dopamine, but not so much."

Teacher: "But what is more fun? Smoking while drinking coffee and shopping at the same time, or going for a walk?"

Teacher: "What's more fun? Of course this, so all other things in life will become boring."

Teacher: "So that's why, walking is boring, talking to friends is boring, showering is boring."

Teacher: "And I just do all of this thing again and again and again."

The Addiction Formula

Easy to get + Gives lots of dopamine = Addiction. The easier something is and the more dopamine it gives, the more addictive it is. Normal activities become boring compared to high-dopamine activities.

Word / Phrase	Pronunciation	Meaning	Example from Class
dopamine	/dɒpəˈmiːn /	多巴胺	Dopamine makes you feel happy.
boring	/bɔːrɪŋ/	无聊的	Walking is boring compared to shopping.
succeed	/səkˈsiːd/	成功	When you succeed, your body makes dopamine.
winner	/ˈwɪnər/	赢家	I did something, I'm a winner.

3. Dopamine Fasting 多巴胺禁食

3.1 Understanding "Fast" 理解"禁食"

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Now, what a lot of people actually do to stop this is called doing a dopamine fast."
Teacher: "Relaxed. Yes, fast. It doesn't mean like, oh, he's very fast, he runs very fast."
Teacher: "It's a different. You guys know this word?"
Teacher: "Breakfast. Why is breakfast called breakfast? Because it's breaking a fast."
Teacher: "Yeah, when you fast, what people mean is you don't eat food."
Teacher: "Right, when you sleep or fast, it can be a noun and a verb."
Teacher: "Once a week. Yeah, and that actually works."

Word / Phrase	Pronunciation	Meaning	Example from Class
fast (n./v.)	/fæst/	禁食；斋戒	When you fast, you don't eat food.
breakfast	/brekfəst/	早餐	Breakfast is breaking a fast.
dopamine fasting		多巴胺禁食	Dopamine fasting actually works.

3.2 How Dopamine Fasting Works 禁食如何生效

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "If you guys are curious, who here, for example, really likes listening to music?"
Teacher: "Is anybody feel like, oh, I listen to music every day, a lot of music?"
Teacher: "Anyone here? No, no, we just normal."
Teacher: "Is there anything you guys like doing the same, everyday you like doing?"
Teacher: "Watching TV show, ok? Like, let's choose like any TV show we watch now, right?"
Teacher: "Yeah, and then don't watch TV show for one week. Everything else same, don't watch it for one week."
Teacher: "Then next week, when you watch it, you'll be like, oh my god, this is so much better than before."

The Mechanism

When you stop a high-dopamine activity for a period, your dopamine baseline drops. When you return to the activity, it feels new and much more enjoyable. Same principle applies to sugar, soda, etc.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Because the dopamine is like, oh, I'm going to go down."

Teacher: "Your body becomes like, oh, we are coming down. Not so many happy things happen."

Teacher: "So when the high dopamine thing happens, you're like, oh. It feels like new again."

Teacher: "Same, yeah, same as anything."

Teacher: "If you eat sugar or like drink Coca Cola every day, it's not special."

Teacher: "But when you stop for a week, you drink it and you know, my god, it's so sweet."

Teacher: "That's what happens. Now, that's what a lot of people do. They do dopamine fasts."

Teacher: "Many different ways to do it, but it actually works."

4. Brain & Information Overload 大脑与信息过载

4.1 Our Brain Loves Novelty 大脑喜欢新奇

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Most of the unhealthy things in our life are not what we eat actually."
Teacher: "Or what we put in our body is what we put in our brain."
Teacher: "Like what you should see, what you should hear and whatnot."
Teacher: "Right, shopping is this one thing all shiny colors, right?"
Teacher: "New thing, new thing, right? Our brains love novelty."
Teacher: "Novelty means anything new, novel, right?"
Teacher: "Novelty, like our brains just love it. We cannot get enough, right?"

Why does our brain love new things?

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Why do our brains love new things?"
Teacher: "I think it is the ancient thing, like if we don't fight or run, we will die."
Teacher: "So, yeah, yeah, it is very ancient thing."
Teacher: "Because like our brain basically likes new information, right?"
Teacher: "Any new information you have may help you live, right?"
Teacher: "And but now, too much information. And too much information maybe we don't need, right?"

Word / Phrase	Pronunciation	Meaning	Example from Class
novelty	/nɒvəlti/	新奇；新颖性	Our brains love novelty.
new	/njuː/	新的	New thing, new thing, right?
ancient	/eɪnʃənt/	古老的	It is very ancient thing.
information	/ɪnfərmeɪʃən/	信息	Too much information.

4.2 Information Overload 信息过载

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "For example, we all have like these kind of apps you can scroll through, right?"
Teacher: "Maybe all funny video, funny video."
Teacher: "But after maybe five, can you remember the last one you watched?"
Teacher: "No, you cannot remember anymore."
Teacher: "And our brain is not like we say it's not like infinite."
Teacher: "Right, you cannot put everything in your brain."
Teacher: "If you put something new, maybe some other thing you forget, right?"
Teacher: "So, how much information you put in your head every day that you don't need?"
Teacher: "And maybe something important you have forgot it, and you don't know."

Key Insight

Our brains love new information because in ancient times, new information could help us survive. But today, we have too much information. Our brains are NOT infinite — when we put new information in, we forget other things.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Yeah, so that's what happens."
Teacher: "Now, so, to keep like maybe healthy mind in today's world."
Teacher: "What do you think should people do? Let's start like on an individual level."
Teacher: "So, what should one person do?"

5. Individual Strategies 个人应对策略

5.1 Build a Routine 建立规律

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Maybe we should create a new team."
Teacher: "Maybe, have a routine. Yeah, our routine, our brain also likes things we know already."
Teacher: "So, if you say like, every day from this time to this time, I don't do this, or I do this, right?"
Teacher: "Can you do it? Every week, your brain is a bump."
Teacher: "And you stood, becomes new part of life."

Word / Phrase	Pronunciation	Meaning	Example from Class
routine	/ruːtiːn/	日常规律 ; 惯例	Have a routine.
habit	/hæbɪt/	习惯	You can have bad or good habits.
every day		每天	Every day from this time to this time.

5.2 Take Baby Steps 小步前进

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Baby stepped. Baby steps."
Teacher: "Make a small change every single day."
Teacher: "Work a small change every single day."
Teacher: "Oh, that could work, but might be overwhelming for most people, right?"
Teacher: "Every single day new thing."
Teacher: "Maybe after a week, you're tired, like, already stop this and this and this and this."
Teacher: "I told myself you need to make it, even though it's small."
Teacher: "Small change in every week, every single week."

Start Small

Don't try to change everything at once. Small changes every week, not every day. Start with easy things like walking 5 minutes more. After two weeks, your brain adapts.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "And what you do, if like small thing is like."
Teacher: "Oh, maybe walk 5 minutes more every day, right?"
Teacher: "That's pretty easy to do, right? That's not really hard."
Teacher: "But like if you said, OK, and then no sugar, and then exercise three hours every day, and then like no TV, and no this, out like just become a monk, right?"
Teacher: "And after that in the modern world, you cannot live. Like a monk in the modern world."

5.3 Replace Bad Habits 替代坏习惯

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Find the others into its sales."
Teacher: "Yeah, yeah, yeah, so we like what?"
Teacher: "Yeah, we, yeah, just to walk on like that before change happens."
Teacher: "Habits, so you can have bad or good habits."
Teacher: "Habit just means you do some every day, right?"
Teacher: "So you have some good habits like for example."
Teacher: "Do you personally have some bad habits? And what do you think you can exchange it with?"

Examples of Habit Replacement:

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "So you just need to change. Actions. You just need to change what you do, right?"
Teacher: "Before maybe you're like, oh, shopping makes me feel so happy, blah blah blah."
Teacher: "Maybe change it to, I don't know, every time you feel like shopping, just like, oh, go for a walk."
Teacher: "Or maybe drink some sweet thing, right?"
Teacher: "Usually like, less sugar, it gives you dopamine, so it can make you feel happier."
Teacher: "So you can have like zero sugar."
Teacher: "That's what a lot of people would like smoke or like drinking, like they drink a lot, they cannot stop."
Teacher: "After they just drink like a zero sugar soda."
Teacher: "Like soda, because it also makes you feel happy, you feel like you're drinking something."
Teacher: "But you know it's not that bad for you, compared to other things."

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "So we can change to exercise, smoking, a lot of people change to what?"

Teacher: "Gum, chewing gum, right?"

Teacher: "Smoking, why is it the number one bad thing?"

Teacher: "Because you are doing something, you're going outside, it's like all these things."

Teacher: "They kind of make you feel happy, need to change."

Teacher: "How you move, so you just go outside like that, you feel like you're doing something."

Teacher: "But it's not so bad."

5.4 Make it Harder 增加难度

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "We need to make it hard, slow it down, and change to something else."

Teacher: "All these addictions we have like food, right? Follow everything."

Teacher: "These are very ancient. Our brains are like very ancient."

Teacher: "But in today's world, it's too easy to do these things."

Teacher: "That's why we have problems. We need to make them harder."

Delete Apps:

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Drop the delivery apps."

Teacher: "One thing is like of course, delete apps."

Teacher: "It sounds very simple, right? Oh, it's too too simple, right?"

Teacher: "But you know how many people you know have actually done this, right?"

Teacher: "Oh, delete apps. Very good way to do it."

Teacher: "If you want food, what would you go? You have to go to a restaurant maybe, right?"

Teacher: "It's kind of like slow sit down, on your way there you can think about, you know, like doing the right thing or something."

Cook Yourself:

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Another thing, what's the last time you've been to a supermarket, right?"

Teacher: "We like to buy products, right?"

Teacher: "You can just like walk around in supermarket store."

Teacher: "Pick your own food, cook your own food."

Teacher: "See, you're slowing it down."

Teacher: "You're making it more difficult to have addiction, right?"

Teacher: "And not only that, you're also learning a new skill."

Teacher: "Right, and you still, and you information in your hand, that's good for you."

Use Bicycles:

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "So, what a lot of people also do, maybe they don't have cars."

Teacher: "Instead of cars, they use bicycles, they just buy bicycles."

Teacher: "Actually, if you live in Shanghai, you don't need to."

Teacher: "Oh, yeah, of course of course."

Teacher: "But like, I'm talking about the general, right?"

Teacher: "Like cars in some countries are pretty easy to get, for example, like in US, everybody has a car."

Teacher: "But what some people do is just like, no. So that thing, make it more difficult, slow it down."

Teacher: "Just use bikes."

Teacher: "So instead of like in the car, you just always sitting, at work, always sitting, going home, always sitting."

Teacher: "You actually something, some moving around, and you put it in your everyday life."

6. Willpower 意志力

6.1 What is Willpower? 什么是意志力？

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Anybody know what's willpower?"
Teacher: "Willpower is like power of your mind kind of thing."
Teacher: "All people have willpower, but different people have different levels."
Teacher: "Remember last time we talked about muscles, right?"
Teacher: "Willpower is just like a muscle, right?"
Teacher: "Like some people have more, some people have less."
Teacher: "But one thing you can do is you can exercise it."

Word / Phrase	Pronunciation	Meaning	Example from Class
willpower	/wɪlˈpaʊər/	意志力	Willpower is just like a muscle.
muscle	/ˈmʌsəl/	肌肉	Remember we talked about muscles.
exercise	/ˈeksəsaɪz/	锻炼	You can exercise willpower.
level	/ˈlevəl/	水平；级别	Different people have different levels.

6.2 Willpower Throughout the Day 意志力的日常变化

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Right, for example, let's say every time, like, it's like a muscle."
Teacher: "Like, when you sleep well, you have a lot of it."
Teacher: "When you sleep well, you feel healthy, you have a lot of it, right?"
Teacher: "So after work, maybe you're like come home, you still have some willpower."
Teacher: "You still have some energy, so you can do, make it to do good things, right?"
Teacher: "Right, but if you don't sleep well, or maybe you have lots of addictions or whatnot."
Teacher: "With this, you don't have a lot, you don't have a lot."

Willpower Depletion

When you sleep well, you have full willpower. During the day, every decision and difficult task uses up willpower. By evening, willpower is depleted — that's why bad habits happen more at night.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "When you see some while scrolling, you see some, you look at, cannot stop."

Teacher: "And you just order it, right? Is because you don't have this, right?"

Teacher: "So, we need to exercise it."

Teacher: "Everything you do in life kind of takes this."

Teacher: "So, maybe after one hour, you have this much."

Teacher: "And then after, you're like, oh, after lunch, you have this much."

Teacher: "And then in the day, it goes down and down and down and down."

Teacher: "That's why usually by the end of the day, you like have more bad habits happening."

Teacher: "Is because all your willpower is gone."

Teacher: "Your body cannot use energy, any like brain energy to say no."

6.3 How to Exercise Willpower 如何锻炼意志力

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "How do we exercise willpower?"
Teacher: "Well, we know it's just like a muscle. How do you exercise muscle?"
Teacher: "You must do something that it has never done before."
Teacher: "Sulting so hard that it has no choice, can only grow and change."
Teacher: "Same thing with here."
Teacher: "Right, so how do we improve our willpower?"
Teacher: "Do something never done before."
Teacher: "Does that mean? Limits, torture limits."

Practical Examples:

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Dancing is my option."
Teacher: "Dancing is your option? Well, dancing could be."
Teacher: "For example, dancing is a difficult thing, right? You need to do something."
Teacher: "Need to find my rubber. Yeah, did it."
Teacher: "Yeah, yeah, if they need to do something difficult, right?"
Teacher: "Different thought, and good for us."
Teacher: "Right, when you do something difficult goods for us."
Teacher: "You can start slow, you can start a little bit, right?"

Start Slow & Build Routine

Do something difficult that's good for you. Start small — maybe 30 minutes a day. Build a routine. After about two weeks, your brain adapts and it no longer feels difficult. You have grown new "muscle".

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "We can have a routine, routine very important, right?"
Teacher: "Every day. Maybe let's say you come home at 6:30."
Teacher: "You have like a snack and then at 7 to like maybe 7:30, only 30 minutes, right?"
Teacher: "I think like most people can do that."
Teacher: "You do something difficult, that's good for us."
Teacher: "Right? Right. Most important, we do a little bit."
Teacher: "And that may be after two weeks. Like usually our brain after two weeks it can change."
Teacher: "It doesn't feel difficult. Right, so what happened? You have grown new muscle."
Teacher: "Like here, right? So start slowly, and we can improve our willpower."

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Some people actually are very good at this, right?"

Teacher: "And they have so much willpower, they just like every day maybe like 3 hours."

Teacher: "Like no matter how tired, no matter about city they work and then exercise and blah blah."

Teacher: "Is because they have so much willpower, right?"

Teacher: "But if you have more willpower, of course, when you start the day, you have more, right?"

Teacher: "But it always ends, right? Just like exercise, right?"

Teacher: "You exercise your muscle one time, it'll just cannot be right."

7. FOMO (Fear Of Missing Out) 错失恐惧症

7.1 What is FOMO? 什么是FOMO ?

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Collect to the garbage, like, tall, like. Hip hop car."
Teacher: "OK, OK, that's an interesting one."
Teacher: "We call them forward. That we call us go fording, that's an interesting one."
Teacher: "That is kind of harder to explain what people do."
Teacher: "Like fording is basically for example you buy a computer, right?"
Teacher: "And a computer has a box, you don't throw it away, you keep it somewhere, right?"
Teacher: "You guys do any of that? No, you don't do that."
Teacher: "Like oh, people like only TVs or something like that."
Teacher: "Or like perhaps children do that sometimes as well. Like new toy."
Teacher: "Like some LEGO toy, you don't throw away the box and keep it."
Teacher: "Yeah, you keep it for you, you keep it forever."
Teacher: "And like you put it like under the bed or like in the closet or something."

Why do people hoard?

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Why do people have this?"
Teacher: "Child of trauma, child of trauma, it could be."
Teacher: "But like hoarding. Why did people born?"
Teacher: "Is because like this kind of thing you might feel them out."
Teacher: "Well you might need it later. OK."
Teacher: "Need to prepare."
Teacher: "Yeah, you might need it later."

FOMO Definition

FOMO = Fear Of Missing Out. It's a constant anxiety that something is happening and you're not there. It's essentially a future anxiety — always afraid of what might happen.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Well, this kind of thinking, it's actually a big problem like people have in the modern world."
Teacher: "A lot of people have this. It's called FOMO."
Teacher: "You ever heard of FOMO?"
Teacher: "Fear of missing out."
Teacher: "Fear of missing out. Do you guys know what it means?"
Teacher: "Yeah, I know that. Oh, what does that mean? Could you explain?"
Teacher: "I have, I think it's hard to use."
Teacher: "Take example like pandemic, like yeah, yeah."
Teacher: "Right. Fear of missing out. What does that mean?"
Teacher: "It means for example, you always have this kind of like anxiety and fear and feeling afraid."
Teacher: "Because something is happening in the world, and you are not there."

Word / Phrase	Pronunciation	Meaning	Example from Class
FOMO	/foʊmoʊ/	错失恐惧症	Fear of missing out.
hoarding	/ˈhɔːrdɪŋ/	囤积	You keep boxes forever.
anxiety	/æŋzaɪəti/	焦虑	You always have anxiety.
fear	/fɪər/	恐惧	Fear of missing out.

7.2 Examples of FOMO FOMO的例子

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Right, from now on, we talked about hoarding."

Teacher: "You have all these boxes, right? Why do you have the want to keep it?"

Teacher: "Because, oh, maybe in the future I will need it."

Teacher: "What if I don't have this? Bad, right?"

Teacher: "It's kind of like a future anxiety."

Teacher: "It's a future anxiety, that means you're always like kind of afraid of the future."

Teacher: "Like, oh, what if this thing happen, what if that thing happen?"

Social Example:

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Another big way, fear of missing out."

Teacher: "It's like let's say you are on a Friday, right?"

Teacher: "And you are maybe tired, you don't want to go anywhere."

Teacher: "You don't want to like talk with friends, just want to stay home, right?"

Teacher: "But then, like you know you need to rest."

Teacher: "But then the part of your brain is like, oh, but what if today my friends go out."

Teacher: "And it is the best night ever, and I'm not there at all."

Teacher: "Right, that's this, right? And a lot of people have this now."

7.3 Solution: Be Present 解决方案：活在当下

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "How do you guys think we need to fix this problem?"

Teacher: "That's a much more difficult problem to fix."

Teacher: "Yeah, I think we Chinese have this. Oh, really? Future order."

Teacher: "Yeah, well, oh, one thing is, oh yeah, all the people have this right."

Teacher: "It actually kind of because of this, also is connected."

Teacher: "It's getting more and more common this kind of problem."

Teacher: "Well, one thing is be present. You guys always present."

Teacher: "Yeah, it means be here, right?"

Be Present

Being present means focusing on what you're doing NOW, not worrying about the future or what others are doing. It's a skill you can train.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "A lot of the times maybe you like in a meeting or somewhere you think about."

Teacher: "Oh, tomorrow or what? Afterwards, right?"

Teacher: "It's a good thing to have, right? It means you're not dumb, right?"

Teacher: "You're thinking about all future plans, how can I survive or whatnot."

Teacher: "But when you do it too much, you don't stop living."

Teacher: "You're just living in your head always, right?"

Teacher: "So one thing is being present."

Teacher: "Right, when you do something, for example, you guys we talk about exercise, right?"

Teacher: "Dancing, for example, I give you this example to you."

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "You ever like maybe like do some work?"

Teacher: "And then you're like thinking thing, what will I do after?"

Teacher: "After work, I have to go dance. I'd like this, right?"

Teacher: "Yeah, yeah, because you're thinking about what the future, right?"

Teacher: "You're not being present."

Teacher: "But if you kind of like train your brain to be present, what will happen?"

Teacher: "You are not thinking about, oh, what will I do, hard things I will do later."

Teacher: "You're always like, I'm doing this thing now."

Teacher: "And then learn to drive home, and then like dancing, OK, I can do this now."

Teacher: "You're not thinking about after, right?"

Teacher: "After dancing, I have to go cook food. God, you know."

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Is like that, because every time you think like this."
Teacher: "Remember we talked about willpower. Right, your brain is using this every time you think like this."
Teacher: "So by the end of the day, you have nothing, right? You have nothing."
Teacher: "So you need, we need to like kind of train ourselves to be here, right?"
Teacher: "Enjoy here, now think about, oh, after we eat this food, what will we do?"
Teacher: "Don't think about that, right?"
Teacher: "Be present with your friends and whatnot."

8. Oversharing 过度分享

8.1 What is Oversharing? 什么是过度分享？

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Over share, everything."
Teacher: "Over share. OK. Over share, yeah, some people have this problem also. Why?"
Teacher: "I want to know people don't hit you on the head."
Teacher: "Because I think they misunderstand my point all the time."
Teacher: "And maybe because I look young, and think I am so."
Teacher: "I think they think I am so naive, and want to play, have fun with me."

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "But, but like the oversharing like, like it's a common thing, right?"
Teacher: "What is oversharing, you guys know?"
Teacher: "Like maybe when you talk to people, maybe people you just met."
Teacher: "But you tell them too much about yourself."
Teacher: "Or how you feel on what not, right?"
Teacher: "You are like, oh, really really close friends or something like that already."
Teacher: "But like, when you just start, it can be a little bit weird, right?"
Teacher: "It's because why? It's kind of like the need to be understood."
Teacher: "It comes from a need to be understood, right?"
Teacher: "Right, you just want them to know too much about you, right?"

Word / Phrase	Pronunciation	Meaning	Example from Class
overshare	/oʊvərʃeər/	过度分享	Some people overshare with people they just met.

Word / Phrase	Pronunciation	Meaning	Example from Class
naive	/naɪi:v/	天真的	They think I am so naive.
misunderstand	/mɪsʌndərs tænd/	误解	They misunderstand my point.
weird	/wiərd/	奇怪的	It can be a little bit weird.

8.2 Solution 解决方案

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Well, just like before, one thing, it's hard to fix that will be present."
Teacher: "Be present, right?"
Teacher: "Part of being present is kind of knowing what other people are doing right now, right?"
Teacher: "Not think about what you will do in the future."
Teacher: "But oh, I'm doing this right now, other person is doing this."
Teacher: "Other people are feeling like this."
Teacher: "Right, so when you overshare something, you know you overshare it, right?"
Teacher: "So we know you're doing something wrong."
Teacher: "So you can be like, oh, what if other people sitting over this?"
Teacher: "They think, and that's it, how would they feel?"
Teacher: "Right, that's part of being present, it's also like a skill, right?"
Teacher: "How to talk to people, it's like you need to understand how other people are feeling."
Teacher: "Not just that you you you you."

9. Society Level 社会层面

9.1 External vs Internal 外部与内部因素

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Why do people sleep late on weekends?"
Teacher: "Play cell phones."
Teacher: "Cell, just like cell phones, right? Keep your weight."
Teacher: "Too much information makes you feel a happy feeling right now."
Teacher: "Don't want to see anything else."
Teacher: "Like why do people sleep late? Only to pay with phones."
Teacher: "No, because my job."
Teacher: "Yeah, yeah, yeah, so we have like something, we have."
Teacher: "Kind of like external. And eternal. Oh."
Teacher: "External means from outside, internal means from inside."
Teacher: "So, we have different reasons."

External vs Internal

External reasons (job, society) are harder to change. Internal reasons (phone use) are easier to change. Most of the time, internal is easier to change than external.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Your job, the kind of you can't, don't have control."
Teacher: "Your job controls you, so that's kind of external wise to be played, right?"
Teacher: "But we have internal, such as for example playing the phone."
Teacher: "You can control yourself, right? You can control if you play with your phone or not."
Teacher: "So that's an internal reason why people sleep late, right?"
Teacher: "So in today's world, like for example, sleeping late is both."
Teacher: "Internal is easier to change than external, most of the time, right?"

9.2 Society Rules 社会规则

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "So, let's say you sleep late because you play with your phone. What do you do?"

Teacher: "TikTok, hahaha."

Teacher: "Well, I get it, like you play on TikTok, but how do you stop that?"

Teacher: "Keep sleeping, Bill. Well, uh, sure, it might work, might work."

Teacher: "But like, what a lot of people do. It's a, well, never routine, they put rules, right?"

Teacher: "Basically have rules yourself."

What rules can society implement?

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Well, one, well, one thing we talk about before. That rules, right? Have rules."

Teacher: "What kind of rules would you implement to keep like a society healthy?"

Teacher: "Like when you running out to smoking as well, we will have room."

Teacher: "No, if you smoking here, you need to pay."

Teacher: "Why? Yeah, yeah, like that's what a lot of countries do."

Teacher: "Perhaps like if you have smoking in the environment, smoking area, right?"

Teacher: "Right, you cannot smoke everywhere, you must go to a special place."

Teacher: "In many countries already happened."

Teacher: "Number two, what? Make things more expensive."

Teacher: "Yeah, right. If they're expensive, people will have enough thinking like, that stuff is bad for me, spending so much money."

9.3 Modern Work Culture 现代工作文化

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Quit this stupid job."

Teacher: "The job is doesn't want that."

Teacher: "But actually, it is a kind of connected."

Teacher: "For example, before, do you guys know in the 1950s?"

Teacher: "In the America, it used to be called like the golden age. Why?"

Teacher: "Because only one person in the family needed to work."

Teacher: "And it can be like a very easy job."

Teacher: "You can buy a home before you are 35."

Teacher: "You can like have a car, all your children."

Teacher: "You have like 8 or 5 children all go to college before in 1950s like that."

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "There's even like a TV shows about like how men would just go to a store and work there."

Teacher: "Just giving advice what choose to buy. Just like kind of this shop worker."

Teacher: "Yeah, and then from there, yeah, I mean now it's a, it's a... Now it's impossible to have like, right?"

Teacher: "Yeah, but before also like life was like a lot more leisure."

Teacher: "But now, before it was like 9 to 5, right? Now, everything is almost 996, right?"

Teacher: "Soon it will be 997, right?"

Teacher: "So, because of that, people like work more and more and more."

Teacher: "People need to relax more and more and more."

Modern Life Challenge

All these addictions are very fast and easy. People work more, so they need quick relaxation. When you don't work a lot, you could slowly relax. But now, you must have awesome willpower to do that.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Right. All these addictions, they are very fast, right?"

Teacher: "I mean different kind of fast, but they are like fast. Easy, right?"

Teacher: "So you work more of them more, you don't need a lots of time to relax."

Teacher: "Like, when you don't work a lot, you have more free time."

Teacher: "You could just, I wanna go for a walk, and slowly relax."

Teacher: "But now, can't do that no more."

Teacher: "Right, you must... If you can do that, you must have awesome willpower."

Teacher: "Right. Now, but you know sometimes we cannot change the world so quickly."

Teacher: "What we can do is change ourselves, right?"

Teacher: "So, that's the main topic for today."

10. Case Study: Quitting Coffee 案例分析：戒咖啡

10.1 The Problem 问题

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "What about like 5 cups of coffee? How would you help your friends solve that?"

Teacher: "Just like my friends, he can eat 5 cup of coffee every day."

Teacher: "It's too crazy, but he think it's OK."

Teacher: "But he thinks it's OK. Yeah, OK. OK, what about you?"

Teacher: "Oh, I like your Chinese tea. You like Chinese tea more, OK?"

Teacher: "But do you have any like bad, addictions or habits?"

Teacher: "No, maybe every day, I will change the Chinese team, and a lot of can't."

Teacher: "Ok, so you don't have like any bad habits. You think? OK, what about your friend?"

Teacher: "What, 5 cups of coffee a day? Yeah, that's good. 5 days."

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Over share, everything."

Teacher: "And and at all, and we maybe do some sports."

Teacher: "And if you feel tired, you can stand up and do, maybe..."

Teacher: "Yeah, I mean, that's like a basic advice, but do you think it will work?"

Teacher: "Well, why does he drink 5 cups of coffee?"

Teacher: "That's he always be tired. He's always tired."

Teacher: "Well, maybe it's like the this thing."

Teacher: "He always drinks coffee, it makes him too tired."

Teacher: "It after too much, so he needs more coffee."

Teacher: "So maybe like death, you know? It's always going around and around."

10.2 Step-by-Step Solution 逐步解决方案

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Now, but one thing about like these addictions."

Teacher: "All these new addictions, they are very easy."

Teacher: "They're very easy, right?"

Teacher: "So we need to make it what?"

Teacher: "We need to make it hard, we need to maybe slow it down."

Teacher: "For we need to, and kind of like what change to something else."

Teacher: "Well, again, to here. Or we can stop doing another drug, I know."

Teacher: "But like we need to make it hard, slow it down and change to something else, right?"

Teacher: "But it needs to be kind of a similar thing, right?"

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "If he drinks coffee all the time, maybe he needs to change into tea."

Teacher: "Something like that, or something else."

Teacher: "There are many different types of teas, many kind of different drinks."

Teacher: "And do a similar thing as coffee, but maybe not so strong, right?"

The Step-Down Method

Step 1: Switch to Coke Zero (similar experience, less harmful)

Step 2: After 1-2 months, switch to tea

Step 3: Quit tea (much easier than quitting coffee directly)

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Free, yeah, no time free."

Teacher: "So that's why exactly, you just need to, you can do the last one."

Teacher: "Yeah, change something else."

Teacher: "If we change it to sports or like yoga, I mean let's say you are drinking lots of coffee."

Teacher: "Drink coffee, go running right now. Which one do I choose?"

Teacher: "You know, of course people choose the easiest thing, right?"

Teacher: "People always choose the easiest thing."

Teacher: "We need to make it hard."

Teacher: "So what we said rules maybe no coffee, maybe just like other kinds of tea, right?"

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Or remember we talked about? Like zero sugar soda, right?"
Teacher: "Zero sugar soda, a lot of people use that."
Teacher: "Like for food, coffee and whatnot."
Teacher: "Because there's like zero like sugar stuff in there, right?"
Teacher: "So, in a short time, actually, it can help a lot."
Teacher: "Like in one month or two month, you know."
Teacher: "Stop coffee, you just use Coke Zero, right?"
Teacher: "You can use as much as you want, but only like Coca Cola Zero, right?"
Teacher: "But after like two months, then you stop Coca Cola Zero."
Teacher: "Stopping Coca Cola Zero is very easy. Stopping coffee hard."

10.3 Alternative: Make it Harder 替代方案：增加难度

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "So it's kind of like first, you do what? Coke Zero, right?"
Teacher: "Then, you maybe do some like tea."
Teacher: "Then you stop, and then the slide will be broken. Like that."
Teacher: "It's people are addicted to different things."
Teacher: "Because people want different things in life, right?"
Teacher: "So, if you like, addicted to having in the first, like I said."
Teacher: "Slow it down, one way to slow it down, maybe don't order."
Teacher: "If you drink coffee, you must make it yourself."
Teacher: "So you must have like a machine, and you must grind it."
Teacher: "You must make it like that. They need to use hot water and whatnot, right?"
Teacher: "That's one way to an option."

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "So from 5 cups, maybe he will do like 3 cups."
Teacher: "Because it's like, oh. Making it again, it's too annoying."
Teacher: "So he doesn't mess, right?"
Teacher: "Yeah, you can do it like that."

11. Teacher's Personal Experience 老师个人经验

11.1 Overcoming Addiction 克服成瘾

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "What if I have some addictions?"

Teacher: "I mean I used to have."

Teacher: "I used to have some addictions, so like I also like read a lot about this kind of stuff."

Teacher: "So that's why I can kind of know about this."

Teacher: "Once I used to have, I used to have like smoking."

Teacher: "I used to have smoking, but like yeah, stop that basically."

Teacher: "Only smoke when like maybe with some friends go out a little bit."

11.2 The Habit Aspect 习惯的作用

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "It's just the same thing, I just started like chewing gum."

Teacher: "Just started chewing gum."

Teacher: "After a while, like, every time your friends go out to smoke."

Teacher: "You just also want to talk to them, just chew gum."

Teacher: "Just like that's right."

Teacher: "After one month or two, chewing gum is pretty easy to quit."

Teacher: "And you quit that, they means don't just don't feel it."

Key Insight: It's Mostly Habit

People are not addicted to nicotine most of it — it's about the habit. The going out, the smell, the fire, talking with friends, the smoke everywhere. This thing is what you like. Nicotine you can quit pretty easily after one week.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Yeah, because it's like for example, it's a small thing, we have nicotine, right?"
Teacher: "People think nicotine is like hard to quit, but it's pretty easy."
Teacher: "Like nicotine or caffeine, if you can stop for one week, your body is fine."
Teacher: "People are not addicted to nicotine most of it, it's about the habit."
Teacher: "It's the habit, right?"
Teacher: "You go out, you pull the cigarettes, the smell, the fire."
Teacher: "Talking with friends, the smoke everywhere."
Teacher: "Like this thing is what you like."
Teacher: "The nicotine is like you can quit that pretty easily after one week."

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "But this moving, right?"
Teacher: "Maybe every day at noon you smoke, right?"
Teacher: "If you stop right now, next day your life Newman."
Teacher: "Ah, something is missing in my life, right?"
Teacher: "I need something in my life. A big piece of me is gone."
Teacher: "This big piece is they haven't, is they haven't."
Teacher: "Right, even if you do don't have cigarette, just go out and like do this."
Teacher: "You will feel better actually."

11.3 Training Your Brain 训练大脑

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Yeah, it sounds weird, but yeah, yeah."
Teacher: "You're basically exercising your brain."
Teacher: "Because our brain must exercise."
Teacher: "Real loves doing the same thing again and again and again."
Teacher: "So, that's why also our brain likes easy, right?"
Teacher: "Easy things like not complicated."
Teacher: "You need to have willpower, where's goal power?"
Teacher: "Right now again. Need to have willpower to change your brain."
Teacher: "That's it."

12. Class Summary 课堂总结

Today's Key Takeaways

1. Addictions happen because modern life makes high-dopamine activities too easy.
2. Dopamine fasting can reset your sensitivity to pleasure.
3. Willpower is like a muscle — exercise it by doing difficult, new things.
4. Combat addiction: Make it harder, slow it down, change to something healthier.
5. FOMO and oversharing stem from anxiety — being present helps.
6. Our brains love novelty but have limited capacity.
7. Both individual effort and societal rules are needed.

Teacher's Model Sentences (范文)

Teacher: "Anyway, class is up for today, you guys can ponder on this."
Teacher: "Revenge, maybe like addiction, dopamine, novelty, willpower, right?"
Teacher: "And fasting, right?"
Teacher: "You guys can try dopamine fasting if you have some problems."
Teacher: "Right, but dopamine fasting of course we need more willpower."
Teacher: "This is a very high level thing to do."
Teacher: "So. Good luck on your journey to stop some bad habits."

"Good luck on your journey to stop some bad habits!"